

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 743

By Faison

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Representative Gerald Dennis McCormick II of Nashville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of our friend and former colleague Representative Gerald Dennis McCormick II; and

WHEREAS, Representative McCormick was a decorated veteran, respected public servant, and civic leader whose life was defined by principle, integrity, and a deep commitment to the people of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, the former Tennessee House Majority Leader, Gerald McCormick represented the people of Hamilton County's 26th House District with honor and distinction as a member of the 104th, 105th, 106th, 107th, 108th, 109th, and 110th General Assemblies from 2005 until his retirement in 2018; and

WHEREAS, born on February 22, 1962, in Memphis, Representative McCormick was raised in a family that instilled in him the values of service, scholarship, and community engagement, shaping a life devoted to both his country and his fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, after graduating from the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, Gerald McCormick served honorably in the United States Army during the Gulf War as a Nuclear, Biological, and Chemical Defense Specialist; and

WHEREAS, Representative McCormick was elected to the Tennessee House of Representatives in 2005, representing Hamilton County's 26th District with honor and distinction for the next fourteen years; he became one of the State's most influential Republican lawmakers, serving as House Majority Leader from 2011 to 2014 and guiding major legislative reforms in infrastructure, education, and business regulation; and

WHEREAS, among Leader McCormick's most notable achievements was his instrumental support for the Tennessee Promise scholarship program, which expanded tuition-

free community and technical college access to thousands of students; he also played a key role in advancing the IMPROVE Act, one of the largest infrastructure funding efforts in State history; and

WHEREAS, Gerald McCormick was known by colleagues for his calm demeanor, strategic mind, and steady leadership, especially during times of rapid political change; he was equally active outside the legislature, serving on local boards including Blood Assurance and the Chattanooga Area Convention and Visitors Bureau; and

WHEREAS, after retiring from public office in 2018, Representative McCormick joined The Ingram Group, under the leadership of the legendary Tom Ingram, advising on policy and strategic initiatives that particularly related to the State of Tennessee; in 2024, he was awarded the Distinguished Public Service Award by Kappa Alpha Order in recognition of his legacy of servant leadership and civic duty; and

WHEREAS, Gerald McCormick is survived by his beloved wife of thirty-eight years, Kimberly Gant McCormick; daughters, Cooper McCormick and Scottie McCormick Tudor; son-in-law, Graham Tudor; grandchildren, Margaret "Margot" McCormick Betts and Graham "Gray" Arthur Tudor II; his mother, Ruth McCormick; sisters, Patti Anderson and Amy Dawson; mother-in-law, Bobbie Gant; brother and sister-in-law, Zach and Whitney Gant; brother-in-law, Scot Woodard; lifelong friends, Matt Miller and Terry Cowdrey; loyal caregiver, Melissa Rodriguez; and a host of other nieces, nephews, aunts, uncles, fraternity brothers, Army buddies, and friends who were the pride of his life; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his father, Gerald Dennis McCormick I; his sister, Melinda McCormick Woodard; his father-in-law, Harold Winston Gant; and his brother-in-law, Harold Scott Gant; and

WHEREAS, Gerald McCormick leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Gerald Dennis McCormick II, reflecting fondly upon his legacy of service, leadership, and devotion to the people of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Representative McCormick.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.